

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY

Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

In 2016, a landmark study revealed that the sugar industry had paid scientists in the 1960s to **deflect** blame for heart disease away from sugar and onto **saturated fat**.

This **manipulation** of research shaped nutritional advice for decades, contributing to a global health crisis.

Today, Australians consume an average of 14 teaspoons of **added sugar** per day — more than double the World Health Organisation's **recommended** limit.

Sugar is found not only in confectionery but in **seemingly** healthy foods: bread, sauces, yoghurt and breakfast cereals.

Excessive sugar consumption is linked to **obesity**, Type 2 diabetes, tooth decay and increased **cardiovascular** risk.

Food companies have **lobbied** aggressively against sugar taxes and mandatory health labelling, citing **consumer freedom**.

The United Kingdom introduced a **sugar levy** on soft drinks in 2018, resulting in manufacturers **significantly** reducing sugar content — without consumer complaint.

The evidence suggests that individual willpower is an insufficient response to a system **engineered** to maximise consumption.

VOCABULARY HELPER

deflect = redirect attention or blame away from something

manipulation = dishonest control of information or people

lobbied = worked to influence government decisions

sugar levy = a tax specifically on products with high sugar content

cardiovascular = relating to the heart and blood vessels

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

How much do you know about the sugar content of foods you eat regularly? Write 2 sentences:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. What did the sugar industry do in the 1960s?

2. How much sugar do Australians consume per day?

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal reflection on sugar awareness.

A1. Paid scientists to deflect blame for heart disease from sugar onto saturated fat. **A2.** 14 teaspoons of added sugar per day. **A3.** Manufacturers significantly reduced sugar content without consumer complaint. **A4.** Willpower alone is insufficient when the system is designed to maximise consumption.

B1. Pro-regulation — evidence: presents industry manipulation negatively; UK levy is presented as a clear success. **B2.** Accept: Consumer freedom is diminished if consumers are misled — informed choice requires accurate information; the UK example shows regulation works without forcing anyone.

C: 'Seemingly' = qualifier that undermines the assumption — it implies these foods appear healthy but are not; creates distrust of food labels. Statistic: 14 teaspoons vs 6 recommended — the gap makes the problem concrete and alarming.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:

★ ★ ★ ★ ★

EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write a speech to parliament arguing for or against a sugar tax in Australia. Use the UK example, statistics, a rebuttal of 'consumer freedom' and a persuasive conclusion.

PARENT TIP

Read food labels together. Count the grams of sugar in everyday foods. Ask: 'Are you surprised? What changes could we make? Should companies be required to reduce sugar?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to Health and Civics. Students analyse 5 food labels and calculate daily sugar intake. Debate: 'Should the government regulate what food companies can put in products?'

- STUDENT REFLECTION**
- ☐ I can identify an author's bias using specific textual evidence
 - ☐ I can explain how qualifiers like 'seemingly' affect meaning
 - ☐ I can write a sustained argument that incorporates a counter-argument rebuttal